

Trip down nostalgia lane...



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"The more I think about it and stretch my brain back in time, I am convinced that most of my happiest memories are all closely surrounded by technology and gadgets. And I wouldn't have it any other way."

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Last month, while trying to capture a video of my baby daughter's expert handling of a touch-enabled Windows 8 tablet device, I remember smiling to myself and wondering – will she be able to recollect her time spent on the device and her earliest tech distractions well into her adult life? Sure, the video I captured of her would go a long way in acting as a trigger in the future, prompting her to access one of her earliest self-preserved memories, but would she really really remember? Only time would tell, I guess.

Of course, that led me to think really hard and jog my memory for some of my most memorable technology-related memories. Ever since I was a kid, I can vividly remember the introduction of a colour television in our home, because up until then I was only ever used to watching moving visuals in black and white. That was a big moment for me, personally. I can never forget having to live with only 10 channel buttons and a tuner for anything extra – those were the days!

Around the same time I remember creating my first real mixtape, thanks to a friend's Philips audio system that allowed for side-by-side and live radio frequency recording – I can't quite recollect the model number of the set now, and neither can my friend. But both of us remember the hours we spent trying to assemble perfect dance hits cassettes with a mix of Hindi and English songs. Oh the number of vacation hours we spent saving pocket money, buying higher quality recording cassettes for flawless playlists!

Then when VCRs came into vogue, I remember convincing friends to pool up our funds to go rent the latest English movie videocassettes (Rs 10 per day at the time!) – we watched a lot of action movies back in the day, starring Arnold, Sylvester Stallone, and Jean Claude Van Damme. I also remember how one day we rented the movie Hackers and were blown away by the potential of an Internet-connected computer terminal. Needless to say, that was the first time I ever saw glimpses of the Internet. Ever. But, I'm getting ahead of myself.

After dabbling with computers in school and at a friend's place, I fondly remember the

day when I convinced my father to get me my first computer. I didn't sleep the whole night! My excitement levels were through the roof. Of course, I remember putting in a bunch of Digit (at the time CHIP) CDs and trying all the games on them. And the myriad range of software and apps. Very soon my 20 GB hard drive crashed, and I realized the importance of backing up data – which meant saving up more money to buy a CD-ROM writer.

Technology had me pretty much hooked by this time, and I was having a ball of a time. My SEGA Mega Drive II was the object of envy among my friends, dial-up Internet was expanding my frontiers of knowledge (in every imaginable subject!) like never before, and my parents weren't yet complaining about the electricity bill yet. And all this while, technology was transforming itself to help me create more memories – switching from a curved picture tube tele to a flat screen picture tube TV, walkman, CD player, DVD writer, discrete GPU, second and third computer, first phone, first laptop, newer gaming console, LCD TV, wireless Internet, first smartphone, and the list goes on and on.

The more I think about it and stretch my brain back in time, I am convinced that most of my happiest memories are all closely surrounded by technology and gadgets. And I wouldn't have it any other way. And I'm not done quite yet. I'm looking forward to building more memorable, happy technology memories in the coming days. There's so much to look forward to – especially IoT and VR.

I'm sure you have your fair share of tech-related memories dating back to your childhood days. I'd love to hear from you, should you feel the need to share them with me. You know where to email me. Happy tech memories! 